Interview Questions to Ask and Answer

Company Questions

1. What does the management and organizational structure look like here?
2. Where do you see the company in the next five to seven years?
3. What do you like most and least about working here?
4. What is the company culture like in practice, not just on the website?
5. What is the biggest challenge facing the company right now?
6. Who is your biggest competitor, and what do you each do better?
7. If you could change one thing about this company, what would it be?

Position Questions

1. What would my work schedule look like?
2. What kind of work should I expect in the first year?
3. Can you describe a typical day, week, and month in this position?
4. Is this a new position, or am I replacing someone?
5. Could I talk with the last person in this role, or with one of their peers?
6. What are the main challenges someone in this position should expect?
7. How does this role contribute to the team and the company overall?

Training, Pay, and Next Steps

1. How will my performance in this position be measured?
2. What training do you offer for new hires and for current staff?
3. What career paths are open to people in this position?
4. What benefits do you offer: bonuses, vacation, sick leave, insurance?
5. Are people allowed to work remotely, and how much travel is expected?
6. Are there gaps in my qualifications that I could still improve on?
7. What are the next steps, and when will I hear back?

About You

1. Tell me about yourself — what should I know first?
2. What are your strengths, and what is your biggest weakness?
3. Are you willing to travel or to relocate?
4. What sets you apart from the other candidates?
5. Why should we hire you?
6. Are you more detail-oriented or more of a big-picture person?
7. Do you prefer working alone or as part of a team?

Your Work History

1. What are your career goals?
2. What is your greatest professional achievement, and how did you get there?
3. What would you like to be doing in five years?
4. What did you like and dislike about your last boss?
5. Which career rewards matter most to you?
6. Why are you leaving your current job?
7. What was your biggest accomplishment in your last job?

Behavioral Questions

1. Can you give an example of a time you went above and beyond to get a job done?
2. Describe a time you could not meet a deadline. How did you handle it?
3. Have you ever been under pressure to meet many deadlines at once?
4. How have you handled a conflict with a coworker?
5. Can you give an example of a mistake you made, and how you fixed it?
6. Has an assignment ever been too hard for you? What did you do?
7. What idea did you have at work, and how did you put it into action?